

PROGRESSION • TIMELINE • GRAPH

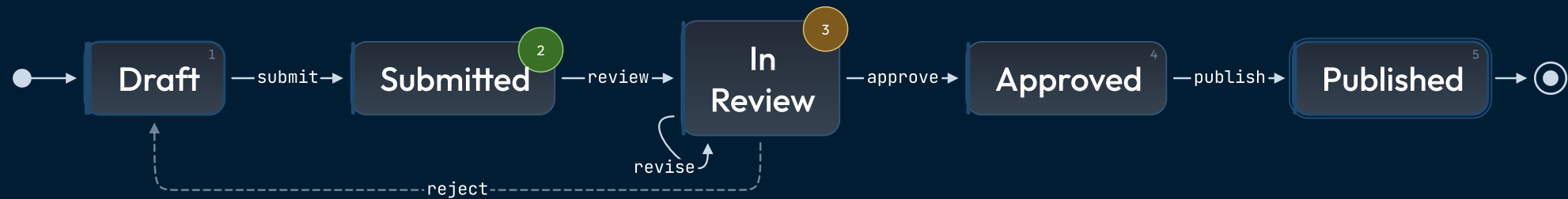
# state-chart

Native state machine diagram — states as a numbered list, transitions as nested inline-code refs.

## SUBMISSION LIFECYCLE

# States connect; the arrows carry the rules.

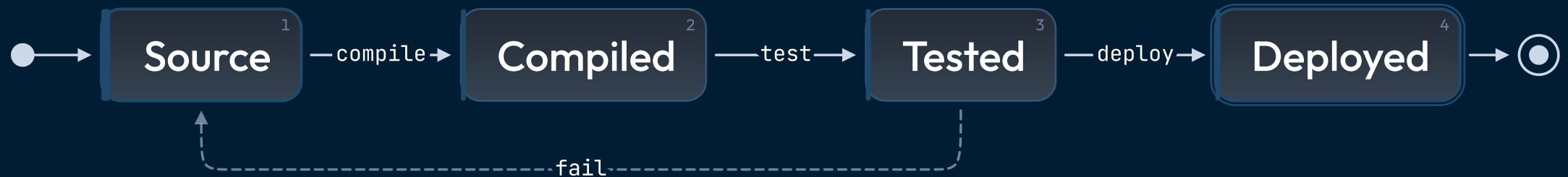
*How a draft moves from author to publication.*



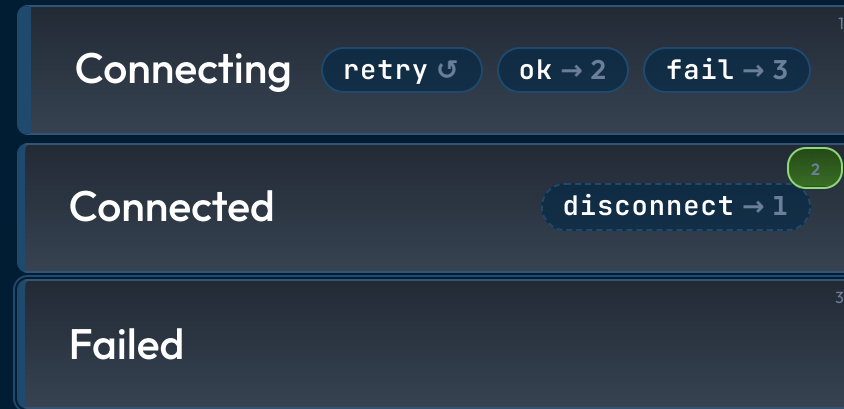
Rejected drafts return to the author; revisions stay in review.

● on-track ● at-risk

# lr flows the states left to right.



# inline sets the chart beside its prose.



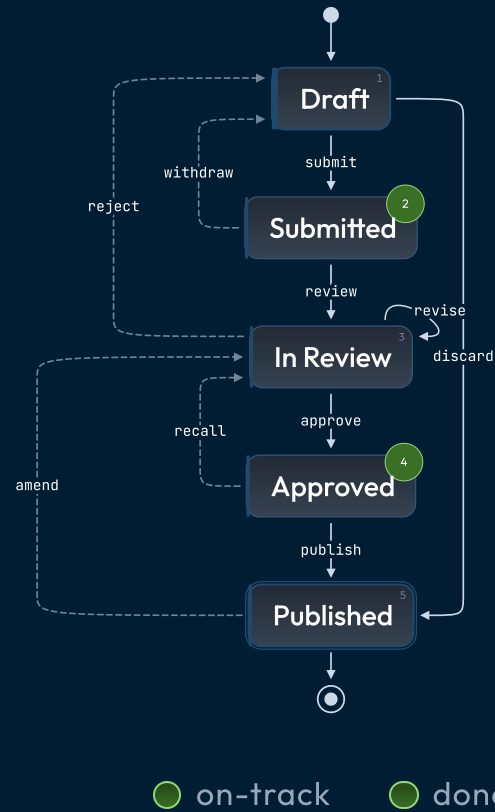
● live

# curved eases the arrows between states.



## SUBMISSION LIFECYCLE

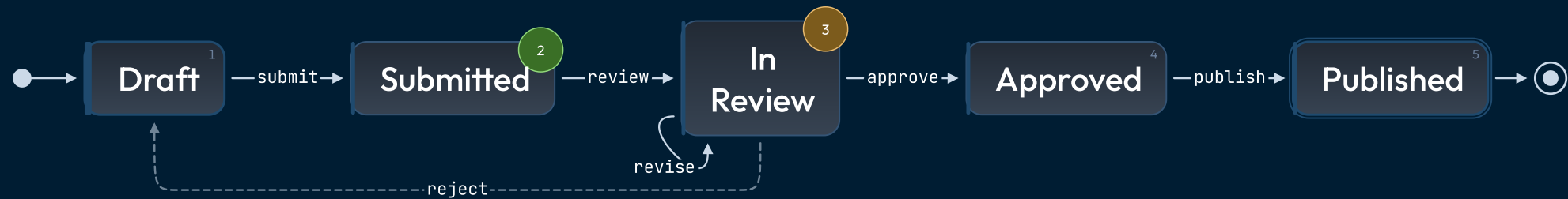
# Stress test — back-edges, skips, self-loop.



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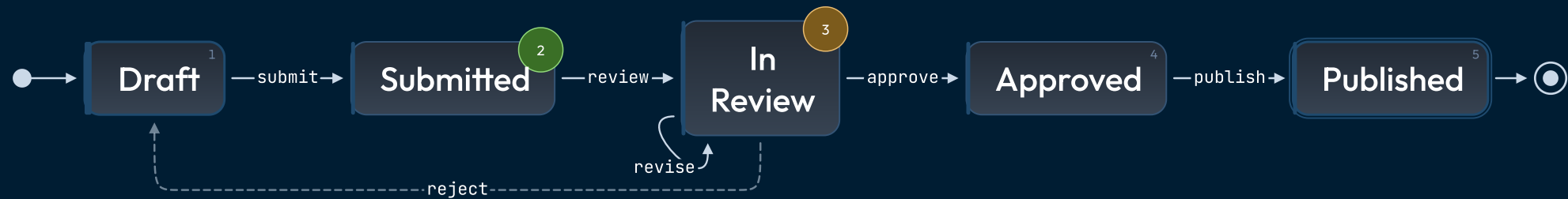
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# When NOT to reach for state-chart.

## More than ~8 states

Vertical stacks of ten or more states stop reading as a machine and start reading as a list. If the system has many states, group them into phases and show one phase at a time, or step back to a higher-level abstraction. The chart's job is to make the topology obvious in one glance.

## Hierarchical or parallel states

v1 grammar is one flat list of states with one outgoing arrow per nested bullet. Composite states, orthogonal regions, history nodes — anything Mermaid's `stateDiagram-v2` does and this layout doesn't — belong in a Mermaid fence via the `diagram` component.

## Continuous processes

If the diagram is really a workflow with stages that overlap or block (queue depth, throughput, capacity), a `gantt` or `kanban` chart reads better. State charts are for discrete, mutually-exclusive states the system flips between.

RELATED COMPONENTS

# See also.

`diagram` — the machine has hierarchical states, parallel regions, or guards that need Mermaid's full state-diagram grammar

`journey` — the sequence is a user's path through tasks with mood / affect, not a system's discrete states

`timeline-list` — events are points in time rather than transitions between named states

`list-steps` — a linear procedure with no branching — state-chart is overkill if there are no choices to make

`roadmap` — parallel workstreams across phases, not a single machine's transitions